

We are looking at expanding our global footprints

In a one-on-one interview with Business Today, Mr Suresh Kumar K V, Director (Marketing), BEL, spoke at length about the Navratna DPSU's plans to tap new export markets even while maintaining steady financial growth and diversifying into new business segments



Suresh Kumar K V
Director (Marketing), BEL

Could you give our readers a bird's eye-view on BEL and its contributions to the nation?

Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL) was established in Bengaluru under the Ministry of Defence, Government of India, in the year 1954 to meet the specialised electronic needs of Indian Defence and develop technology to safeguard the nation. The company pioneered professional electronics in India and was the first in the country to supply Communication Radios, Radars, Night Vision equipment, Sonars and EW systems to the Indian Defence forces. Over the decades, BEL has kept itself abreast of rapid technological advancements and continues to supply advanced products

and systems that are today shaping the future of India's Defence.

BEL, a Navratna PSU, designs, manufactures and supplies state-of-the-art products and systems that empower India's armed forces. We have a strong presence in the fields of Radars & Fire Control systems, Weapon systems, Communication & Network Centric systems, Electronic Warfare & Avionics, Anti-submarine Warfare systems, Electro Optics, Tank Electronics & Gun Upgrades, Homeland Security, civilian products and Strategic Components. A trusted partner for India's Defence forces, BEL exports a wide range of high-tech products and is fast expanding its footprints globally. Defence continues to remain

our primary focus. However, we have further expanded and diversified into various sectors in both Defence and non-defence domains. BEL also played a significant role in modernising India's voting system with the Electronic Voting Machine and VVPAT and supported the fight against COVID-19 by supplying in a short span of three months 30,000 ICU grade ventilators.

Can you tell us how BEL is helping the Government realise the dream of an Atmanirbhar Bharat?

BEL, since inception, has been working towards achieving self-reliance. Responding to the clarion call by the Hon'ble Prime Minister of India, BEL has recalibrated its efforts and is strongly promoting the Government's Make in India initiative by laying strong thrust on in-house R&D and indigenisation, Public-Private Partnerships, Joint Ventures, capacity expansion and modernisation.

The Akash Air Defence Weapon System of BEL is a great success story and shining example of BEL's indigenous design, development and manufacturing drive. The Coastal Surveillance System developed by BEL for the Indian Coast Guard is now being offered to other friendly countries as well as for generating export business. The Weapon Locating Radar, developed indigenously by BEL and DRDO lab LRDE, and its lighter version designed for surveillance in mountainous and high-altitude terrains are proving to be game-changers for India's military.

To ensure that we stay at the forefront of innovation, we invested 6.24% of our